Part 6 Brief · Ship

mcp-ops-server · 19 Oct 2026 · PR #13 · Status: built and verified locally; CI and your review next

WHAT WAS BUILT

- **A production container:** pinned Python 3.12 base, non-root user, Docker health check on a new `/healthz` (no data, no token); the tokens file is mounted at run time, never baked in.
- **CI runs the image as shipped** on every PR: build, issue a token through the image, wait for healthy, then a real MCP round trip (401 without a token, 6 tools, search, book, cancel). From main, after every check passes, the image is published to GitHub Container Registry.
- **The README a reviewer reads first:** live results (Luna and Sol, 30/31 each), run-it-in-30-seconds with Docker, architecture, tools and scopes, security model, known limits; plus a demo GIF rendered from a real run by a script in the repo.

HOW IT WORKS

Piece	Role
Dockerfile	Installs only the server package; runs as uid 10001; HEALTHCHECK calls /healthz.
scripts/smoke_test.py	End-to-end check over HTTP. CI runs it against the container; the test suite runs it against the source server, so it cannot go stale.
ci.yml: container	Build + smoke-test the image on every push and PR.
ci.yml: publish	main only, needs all checks; the only job with packages: write.
docs/demo/record_demo.py	Runs the real commands and renders their actual output to demo.gif.

WHY IT WAS DONE THIS WAY

- **No AWS (your call).** A live URL proves it ran once; CI booting the image on every change proves it keeps working, at $0 and with no public write endpoint to operate. Any container host runs it as is.
- **Honest demo.** The GIF is generated from real command output, and the token is never shown. Every README number links to where it was measured.

WHAT WENT WRONG OR SURPRISED ME (LOGGED IN FAILURES.MD)

- **Non-root cut both ways.** The container user could not read a tokens file in a 0700 folder, so the server exited and my wait loop fell through silently. Now: README uses a plain mkdir (tested as a separate host user), the waits fail loudly, and a missing tokens file prints one clear line.
- **Disclosed:** this session's network re-signs TLS, so my local build used a scratch Dockerfile with one extra certificate line. The shipped Dockerfile has none; CI's container job is the proof.

VERIFY IT YOURSELF

```
ruff check . && python -m pytest -q   # 178 passed (incl. smoke script vs real server)
docker build -t mcp-ops-server . && see README 'Run it' (3 commands)
PR #13 > Checks > container             # the image, built and smoke-tested
```

INTERVIEW TALKING POINT

"It ships as a container that CI boots and tests end to end on every PR, with auth on, as a non-root user. Putting it in the cloud is configuration, not code."

NEXT (YOUR ACTIONS)

1) Codex review, merge. 2) Add **container** to the ruleset's required checks. 3) Settings > General > Change visibility > Public (the ruleset then enforces). 4) After the first publish run: Packages > mcp-ops-server > Package settings > Public, then check the README's docker command.